

ANONYMIZED SOLUTIONS ENGINEERING CASE STUDY

# Keeping a Crisis Team Connected

## When the Primary Collaboration Stack Fails

A Microsoft-independent communications Proof-of-Value for a European industrial group

**POV OBJECTIVE** *Maintain secure crisis communications without depending on the primary Microsoft identity and collaboration environment.*

| CUSTOMER                  | POV GROUP                   | DRIVERS                            | STATUS                          |
|---------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| European industrial group | ~30 crisis-management users | ISO audit action + NIS2 resilience | Technical fit largely validated |

### The challenge

An international European industrial group needed a secure backup communication platform that would remain available even if Microsoft Teams, Microsoft 365, Entra ID, or the surrounding identity stack became unavailable or could no longer be trusted. The Proof-of-Value was driven by an internal ISO-audit action and NIS2-related resilience requirements.

This was not simply a messaging replacement exercise. The customer needed to validate an independent operational fallback across identity, communications, managed devices, and the corporate network.

### PoV success criteria

1. **Independence from Microsoft.** Authentication and communication must continue during a complete outage of Microsoft 365 and Entra ID.
2. **Independent authentication.** Local accounts protected with TOTP-based multi-factor authentication.
3. **Crisis-communication coverage.** Secure messaging, voice and video calls, notifications, and file exchange.
4. **Fit with the enterprise environment.** Operation on mobile, web, and managed desktop endpoints through VPN, proxy, and existing network security controls.
5. **Stability and usability.** Core workflows must remain reliable and straightforward for a team operating under incident pressure.

## My role

I prepared and supported the technical Proof-of-Value from requirements translation through testing and follow-up. My contribution included:

- Translating customer requirements into concrete test scenarios and success criteria.
- Presenting the technical solution, supporting setup, and guiding tests across mobile, web, and desktop clients.
- Analyzing network and connectivity issues together with the customer.
- Documenting findings and agreeing the next technical validation steps.

## The technical turning point

Mobile testing was successful, while web and desktop testing initially encountered connectivity issues. Working with the customer, I narrowed the problem down to the corporate proxy and SSL-inspection configuration rather than the application itself.

**FROM SYMPTOM TO TESTABLE CHANGE** *I provided concrete guidance on required domains and ports and on handling real-time communications within the customer's security architecture. This converted an ambiguous application problem into a specific network change and a clear final test.*

## Outcome and current status

- Mobile use was validated successfully and legal reviews were completed.
- The web and desktop issue was isolated to customer-side proxy and SSL-inspection settings.
- A final test following the global network adjustment remained outstanding.
- The solution's technical fit was largely confirmed, but this was not yet a closed-won customer reference.

## What this demonstrates

**Business impact.** Preserved the Crisis Management Team's ability to coordinate when its primary collaboration environment is unavailable or untrusted.

**Technical depth.** Validated identity independence, MFA, endpoints, network controls, real-time communications, and cross-boundary troubleshooting.

**Trust and enterprise readiness.** Aligned crisis management, security, legal, networking, administration, and executives while translating ISO-audit and NIS2 requirements into test criteria.

*Confidentiality note: This anonymized, generalized case describes an active pre-sales Proof-of-Value, not a published customer reference or completed deployment.*